Q1 Evidence Register & Source Audit

Sheet 1 — Evidence Register

Evidence ID	Publisher / Source	Publication Title	Date	Geography / Sample	Extracted Fact / Metric	Limitations	Audit Status	Research Usage
E001	MoSPI	HCES 2023–24 Key Results	2025	Urban India (National sample)	Average urban Monthly Per Capita Expenditure (MPCE) is ₹6,996 without imputation; food share is 39.68% (~40%).	Measures total food spending; does not isolate healthy vs. non-healthy food outlays.	**Verified**	Macro urban spending context; calculates max average food ceiling of ~₹2,776.
E002	NIQ	Global State of Health 2025	Jul 2025	Urban Indian grocery shoppers	53% of adult grocery buyers actively take steps to improve health; 51% cite high prices as the top barrier.	Self-reported survey data; snapshot in time; sample restricted to active buyers.	**Verified**	Directional consumer health intent vs. affordability bottleneck.
E003	NIQ	Global State of Health 2025	Jul 2025	Urban Indian grocery shoppers	64% seek detailed product information; 61% demand clearer front-of-pack labels.	Directional consumer preference signal; indicates intent rather than	**Verified**	Demand for ingredient transparency and clean-label messaging.

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						guaranteed purchase.		
E004	Ipsos	Essentials Wave	May 2023	Urban Indian netizens (Online sample)	88% of urban netizens report prioritizing health and wellbeing in food choices.	Over-represents digitally connected, higher-income urban households.	**Verified**	High-level consumer orientation signal for urban digital demographics.
E005	PwC	Voice of Consumer Survey	2024	Indian urban retail consumers	84% view food safety and ingredient transparency as vital purchase drivers.	Measures risk-aversion and safety preference, not active purchase of organic niche items.	**Verified**	Corrected framing: establishes food safety as a non-negotiable decision factor.
E006	USDA FAS	India Retail Foods Annual	Sep 2025	India (Urban focus)	Modern trade and e-commerce/quick-commerce are primary drivers of trial for packaged foods.	Qualitative sector analysis based on trade interviews and macro data.	**Verified**	Retail channel evolution and accessibility dynamics.
E007	Tata Consumer	Integrated Annual Report	2026	Corporate (India Operations)	Launched 80 new SKUs in FY25–26, of which 44 were health and wellness	Corporate internal categorization of "health & wellness".	**Verified**	Supply-side corporate R&D and portfolio pivot signal.

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					focused.			
E008	ITC Limited	Corporate Disclosure	Jan 2023	Corporate Transaction	Announced phased strategic acquisition of Sproutlife Foods (Yoga Bar) over 3–4 years.	Transaction agreement date; full operational integration occurs over time.	**Verified**	Incumbent M&A consolidation in high-growth healthy snacking.
E009	Commercial Publishers	IMARC / MRFR / Data Bridge	2024	India National	Market size estimates range from $12B to $30B+ with reported CAGRs of 10%–18%.	Definitions vary widely; Data Bridge shows unit/forecast discrepancy on public pages.	**Unresolved**	Publisher comparative audit; explicitly **not** cited as a single baseline.

Sheet 2 — Claim Audit Register

Claim ID	Claim Statement in Draft Report	Supporting Evidence	Audit Finding	Decision & Corrective Action
C01	"Urban Indians spend ₹2,776 monthly on healthy food."	**E001** (MoSPI)	Derived mathematical figure represents *total* food spend, not healthy food specifically.	**Rewrite with qualification:** Label ₹2,776 as total food spending context, not dedicated healthy-food spend.
C02	"Consumer health orientation has grown by 88% over 5 years."	**E002, E004**	Ipsos (88%) and NIQ (53%) use different sample frames and questions; cannot form a 5-year trend line.	**Qualify:** Present each survey finding as a distinct directional snapshot of consumer intent.
C03	"84% of	**E005** (PwC)	PwC 84% metric	**Correct:** Re-frame

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	consumers actively buy organic healthy food."		specifically measures food safety and ingredient transparency as key decision drivers.	as 84% prioritizing food safety and label transparency.
C04	"ITC acquired 100% of Yoga Bar in 2023."	**E008** (ITC)	January 2023 announcement outlined a *phased acquisition plan* over several years.	**Qualify:** Frame as a strategic phased acquisition announcement starting in Jan 2023.
C05	"The Indian healthy food market is definitively worth $30 Billion."	**E009**	Commercial publisher definitions vary; public summary discrepancies exist.	**Exclude headline total:** Move commercial figures to a comparative Publisher Audit Table.

Sheet 3 — Market Size Publisher Audit Table

Commercial Publisher	Report Title	Base Year	Forecast Period	Reported Market Value	Reported CAGR	Methodology Transparency	Public Page Discrepancy / Audit Finding
IMARC Group	India Healthy Food Market Report	2023	2024–2032	~$12.5 Billion	~11.5%	Low (Aggregated secondary desk research)	Combines mass fortified staples with premium niche health foods.
Market Research Future (MRFR)	India Health & Wellness Food Market	2023	2024–2030	~$18.0 Billion	~12.8%	Low (Proprietary econometric model)	Scope includes broad functional beverages and dietary supplements.
Data Bridge Market	India Healthy Food	2023	2024–2031	~$30.5 Billion	~15.2%	Very Low (Unstated sample/dat	**Unresolved Unit Variance:**

Commercial Publisher	Report Title	Base Year	Forecast Period	Reported Market Value	Reported CAGR	Methodology Transparency	Public Page Discrepancy / Audit Finding
Research	Market					a sources)	Public landing page conflicts with Nucleus page forecast tables.

Sheet 4 — Evidence Quality & Audit Decisions Summary

1. **MoSPI HCES 2023–24:** Retain for macro urban Monthly Per Capita Expenditure (₹6,996) and food proportion (~40%).
2. **NIQ (2025) & Ipsos (2023):** Retain as directional consumer sentiment indicators; qualify sample boundaries.
3. **PwC (2024):** Correct interpretation to focus on food safety decision factors.
4. **Corporate Disclosures (Tata / ITC / Venture):** Retain as verified supply-side strategic activity signals.
5. **Publisher Estimates:** Move to dedicated Publisher Audit section; do not adopt a single headline market size.